# IDEATION PHASE

## Empathy Map Canvas

| PROJECT ID | SWTID-2026-1705 |
|---|---|
| TITLE | AUTOMATING EMPLOYEE DATA |

### Says (User Says)

- The users want an automated system that reduces manual work in employee data management.
- Employees say that employee details such as name, email, department, and manager information should be automatically displayed in the incident form.
- Users also say that data entry should be simple, fast, and accurate. They expect the system to eliminate repeated manual searching and improve workflow efficiency.

### Thinks (User Thinks)

- Users think that automation will improve system performance and reduce workload.
- They believe that manual data entry may lead to errors.
- Users expect secure and reliable data processing.
- They also think that employee information should be easily accessible when creating incident records

**Does (User Actions)**

Users log into the ServiceNow platform to manage incident records.

They import employee data using Import Sets.

Users configure Transform Maps to move data from staging tables to target tables.

Mapping Assist is used to map source and destination fields.

Users select employee records in reference fields to automatically populate department, email, and manager details.

**Feels (User Emotions)**

Users feel satisfied when employee details are automatically filled in the incident form.

They feel frustrated when manual data entry is required.

Users feel confident when the system provides accurate employee information.

They feel relieved when incident management becomes easier and faster.

**Pain Points (Problems)**

●Manual employee data lookup consumes time.

●Data entry mistakes may occur during manual processing.

●Tracking employee information can be difficult.

●Incident resolution may be delayed due to lack of automation. ●System

dependency on external data sources may create complexity.

## Goals and Needs

- The main goal of this project is to automate employee data import using ServiceNow platform.
- The system should automatically display department, email, and manager information using dot walking technique.
- The project aims to reduce manual work, improve data accuracy, and enhance incident management efficiency.

## System Benefits

- ServiceNow provides workflow automation and data integration capabilities.
- Import Sets help import external employee data.
- Transform Maps help transfer data between tables.
- Dot walking enables easy retrieval of reference table information.

# Brainstorming Template

## Problem Understanding

The organization receives employee data from an external system.

Manual entry causes:

Data errors

Time consumption

Missing manager information

Incident management needs quick access to employee and manager details.

Key Questions

How can employee data be imported automatically?

How can incident forms show manager details automatically?

How can priority be customized for incidents?

# Main Idea

Automate employee data import and improve incident handling by using ServiceNow features.

## Core Technologies

- Import Sets
- Transform Map
- Dot Walking
- Dictionary Override

## Brainstorming Areas

### Data Source Preparation

## Ideas:

- Google Sheets
- Excel file

CSV file

XML file

**Data Fields:**

Name

Email

Department

Manager

Manager Email

**Possible Improvements:**

Auto sync with HR system

Scheduled imports

Data validation

## Data Import Process

### Tools:

Import Sets

Load Data Module

Brainstorm Questions:

How to create staging table?

What file format is best?

How often should data import happen?

Expected Result:

Employee data automatically stored in user table.

## C. Data Transformation

Key Tool: Transform Map

Ideas:

Map source fields to target fields.

Use auto field matching.

Use mapping assist for complex fields.

Example:

| Source Field | Target Field |
| --- | --- |
| Name | sys_user.name |
| Email | sys_user.email |
| Manager | sys_user.manager |

## Incident Form Automation

Technique: Dot Walking

**Ideas:**

Automatically display department.

Show manager information.

Display manager email.

**Example Fields:**

Assigned To → Department

Assigned To → Manager

Assigned To → Email

**Benefits:**

Faster incident handling

Less manual lookup

**Priority Customization**

Technique: Dictionary Override

**Ideas:**

Change default priority only for incident table.

Keep task table unchanged.

**Example:**

| Table | Default Priority |
| --- | --- |
| Task | 4-Low |
| Incident | 3-Moderate |

**Benefits:**

Incidents get higher urgency.

Better incident management.

**Possible Challenges**

Incorrect field mapping

Missing employee records

Import errors

Wrong default values

**Solutions:**

Validate data before import

Use transform logs

Test mapping before deployment

**Expected Outcomes**

Automatic employee data import

Incident forms display manager details automatically

Custom priority for incidents

Faster incident resolution

**Benefits**

Saves time

Improves data accuracy

# Problem Statement

## Introduction to the Problem

In modern organizations, managing employee information and handling incidents efficiently are essential for maintaining smooth IT service operations. Many companies use platforms such as ServiceNow to manage tasks, incidents, and user records. However, employee information is often stored in external systems such as HR databases, spreadsheets, or other enterprise software. Because of this separation, organizations frequently face challenges when trying to keep employee data synchronized with their ServiceNow environment.

Typically, new employee details such as name, email address, department, manager, and manager email are stored in external sources like Excel sheets or HR systems. These records must be regularly added to the ServiceNow user table to ensure that employees can be assigned incidents, tasks, and service requests. When this process is performed manually, it becomes time-consuming and prone to errors. Manual data entry can result in incomplete records, duplicate entries, and incorrect information, which may negatively impact the efficiency of IT service management processes.

Automating Employee Data Import

Another important challenge occurs during incident management. When an incident is created in ServiceNow and assigned to an employee, service desk agents may need to access additional information about the employee, such as their department or manager details. In many cases, these details are not directly visible on the incident form. As a result, the support team may need to open multiple records or search through other tables to find the necessary information. This extra effort slows down the incident resolution process and reduces productivity.

## Issues with Manual Data Handling

Manual management of employee data can create several operational problems within an organization. First, manually importing or updating employee records from external systems requires significant effort from administrators. Every time a new employee joins the company or when existing employee details change, the information must be updated in the ServiceNow system. This repetitive process increases administrative workload and creates opportunities for mistakes.

Second, inconsistent data can lead to confusion when assigning incidents. For example, if the employee's department or manager information is missing or incorrect, the incident may be assigned to the wrong person

or may not reach the correct escalation path. This can delay the resolution of issues and affect service quality.

Third, the absence of automatically populated information on the incident form makes it difficult for support staff to quickly understand the organizational context of the employee who reported the issue. Ideally, when an incident is assigned to a user, the system should automatically display relevant details such as the user's department, email address, and manager. Without this feature, support agents must manually search for the required information, which increases response time.

Another issue involves the configuration of default values within ServiceNow tables. In the ServiceNow platform, many tables extend from the parent **Task** table. These child tables often inherit the same default field values from the parent table. However, in real-world scenarios, different types of tasks require different priority levels. Incidents, for example, often require faster attention compared to other tasks. Therefore, the default priority value inherited from the Task table may not be suitable for the Incident table.

Automating Employee Data Import

## Need for Automation

To address these challenges, organizations need an automated solution that can simplify the process of importing employee data and improve the efficiency of incident management. Automation can significantly reduce manual work, minimize data entry errors, and ensure that employee information remains accurate and up to date within the system.

One possible solution is to use ServiceNow's **Import Sets** feature to automatically import employee data from external files such as CSV, Excel, or XML formats. Import sets allow administrators to load external data into a staging table and then transform it into the target table within the ServiceNow database. By using transform maps, the fields from the external data source can be mapped to the appropriate fields in the ServiceNow user table.

Another important improvement is the use of **Dot Walking**. Dot walking allows the system to retrieve related information from linked tables without opening additional records. For example, when an incident is assigned to a specific user, dot walking can automatically display the user's department, email, and manager details directly on the incident form. This functionality helps support agents quickly access important information without navigating through multiple tables.

Additionally, ServiceNow provides a feature called **Dictionary Override**, which allows administrators to modify the default properties of fields in extended tables. Using this feature, the default priority value for incidents can be customized without affecting the parent Task table or other child tables. This ensures that incidents receive an appropriate default priority level that reflects their urgency and impact.

## Overall Problem Definition

The main problem addressed in this scenario is the inefficiency caused by manual data management and the lack of automated information display within the ServiceNow platform. Organizations require a system that can automatically import employee information from external sources, maintain accurate user records, and provide relevant details directly within incident forms.

Without such automation, the organization may experience delays in incident resolution, data inconsistencies, and increased administrative workload. These issues can negatively affect the overall performance of IT service management processes.

Therefore, there is a need to implement a solution that integrates automated employee data import, dynamic information retrieval through dot walking, and customized field configurations using dictionary overrides. This approach will enhance data accuracy, improve the visibility of important employee details during incident handling, and streamline the entire incident management workflow.